



New anti-stress diet that will *banish* your 'cortisol belly' too!



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HALF A MILLION IN 12-HOUR A&E TROLLEY HELL

Shock figures for 2024 show record numbers hit by NHS bed shortages... and that was BEFORE this year's growing flu crisis

By **Shaun Wooller**
Health Editor

HOSPITALS left a record 518,000 patients languishing on trolleys in A&E for 12 hours or more last year, damning figures reveal.

The rate is 400 times higher than the 1,306 reported a decade ago and comes amid a major shortage of beds preventing staff moving new arrivals on to wards.

It shows emergency departments were already dangerously overwhelmed before the emergence of this winter's flu outbreak, forcing around 20 trusts to declare 'critical incidents'.

NHS England said an average of 5,408 patients a day were in hospital with flu last week, including 256 in critical care.

It believes this number will rise now children have returned to school, where they risk catching the virus and taking it home to families and vulnerable relatives. Carrie Johnson, wife of **Turn to Page 4**



LA fires delay the launch of Meghan's new Netflix show

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